



BEFORE THE POUR: 30 CHECKS

Once the concrete is in, every mistake is permanent, and fixing it means a saw, a jackhammer or an engineer's letter. Run this list the day before and again the morning of the pour. Print it and hand it around.

BUILDERS & GCS

CREWS & FOREMEN

EVERY TRADE IN THE SLAB

HOMEOWNERS

1 PAPERWORK & INSPECTIONS

NO SIGN-OFF, NO POUR

- ☐ **Permit on site, latest approved drawings in hand.** Check the revision date. Everyone works off the same set. **BUILDER**
- ☐ **Required inspections booked and passed.** The municipal footing/foundation inspection, plus the engineer's field review where the design calls for one. **BUILDER**
- ☐ **Layout verified.** Setbacks, gridlines and elevations checked against the site plan. A form survey is done if your municipality requires one. **BUILDER**
- ☐ **Mix ordered to spec.** Strength (MPa), exposure class, air content, slump and aggregate size, all matching the drawings. **BUILDER CREW**
- ☐ **Volume, start time and truck spacing confirmed with the plant.** Order a small overage so you're not short on the last wall. **CREW**

2 FORMS

BLOWOUTS START WHERE NOBODY CHECKED

- ☐ **Dimensions and diagonals checked.** Forms square, plumb and in line with the drawings.
- ☐ **Bracing, stakes and walers solid.** Walk the full run and push on it.
- ☐ **Top of pour marked** with grade nails, a chalk line or tape, so the finisher knows where to stop.
- ☐ **Ties at the form system's spacing;** release agent on the panels.
- ☐ **Bulkheads and keyways set** wherever the pour stops (planned cold joints).
- ☐ **Bottom clean.** No mud, standing water, debris, frost or ice. Footings bear on undisturbed or properly compacted soil.

3 REBAR

THE PART NOBODY SEES AGAIN

- ☐ **Size, spacing and laps match the drawings;** laps tied.
- ☐ **Cover is right.** Chairs and dobies hold steel off the ground and off the forms (typically 75 mm where concrete is cast against earth; confirm on your drawings).
- ☐ **Dowels and verticals tied in place.** No "wet-sticking" unless the engineer allows it.
- ☐ **Steel is clean:** no mud, oil or loose, flaky rust.
- ☐ **Corner bars and extra bars at openings** placed as detailed.



4 EVERY TRADE: WHAT GETS BURIED

GET EACH TRADE'S OK BEFORE THE TRUCK

- ☐ **Plumbing:** sleeves for sewer, water and drain lines through footings and walls. Under-slab rough-in tested and inspected. **PLUMBER**
- ☐ **Electrical:** grounding electrode (concrete-encased / "Ufer") in place if the electrician specified it; conduit sleeves set. **ELECTRICIAN**
- ☐ **Framing:** anchor bolts and hold-downs at the right spacing, embedment and location. Use templates; don't eyeball them. **FRAMER**
- ☐ **Mechanical & gas:** sleeves for lines and venting; radon / soil-gas rough-in where required. **HVAC GAS**
- ☐ **Drainage:** perimeter drain tile plan agreed, and every under-slab or through-wall sleeve in. **BUILDER**
- ☐ **Openings:** beam pockets, window bucks and blockouts in the right place and braced. **FRAMER CREW**
- ☐ **Photograph everything:** rebar, sleeves and embeds, before the pour. When it's buried, the photos are your only record. **EVERYONE**

5 SITE, WEATHER & CREW

POUR DAY RUNS ON PREP

- ☐ **Truck and pump access:** path clear, ground firm enough, washout spot set. Never wash out into a storm drain.
- ☐ **Overhead power lines located.** The pump boom stays outside WorkSafeBC limits of approach.
- ☐ **Forecast checked.** Have a cold-weather plan (blankets, heat) if it's heading under 5 °C, and a curing plan for hot or windy days.
- ☐ **Crew briefed:** who's on the hose, vibrator, screed and finish. Agree hand signals with the pump operator.
- ☐ **Tools ready:** a vibrator plus a backup, screeds, floats, water, and lights if it runs late.
- ☐ **PPE for wet concrete:** waterproof gloves, boots with pants over the top, eye protection. Wet concrete burns skin.

6 AFTER THE POUR

BONUS

- ☐ **Cure and protect.** Keep it moist or covered and protected from freezing. Strip forms and backfill only when the engineer or spec says so.

✓ POUR-DAY SIGN-OFF

EVERY TRADE INITIALS BEFORE THE FIRST TRUCK

TRADE / ITEM	CHECKED BY	INITIALS	TIME
Forms & rebar			
Inspection / engineer			
Plumbing			
Electrical			
Framing (bolts / hold-downs)			
Mechanical / gas			

Homeowner? You don't need to check the rebar yourself, but you can ask your contractor two questions: "Did the inspection pass?" and "Can I see the photos before the pour?" A good crew says yes right away.